

# THE DAILY BRIEF

SEPTEMBER 23, 2026

## MARKETS & FINANCE

*Major market moves, monetary policy, and commodities*

**Fed Delivers First Rate Hike Since 2023, Signals Another Is Coming.** The Federal Open Market Committee voted 12-0 on September 16 to raise the federal funds target range by 25 basis points to 3.75%-4.00%, its first increase since July 2023. Updated projections now show 16 of 18 participants expecting at least one more 25bp hike by year-end, with a median 2026 policy rate near 4.1%. Chairman Kevin Warsh framed the move as a "firm unanimous decision" driven by inflation "too high for too long," 3.7% PCE (revised up from 3.6%), resilient domestic spending, and Middle East tensions feeding energy prices. Treasury yields initially fell — the hike was priced in — but the SEP dot-plot pulled the dollar higher and pressured bullion. (CNBC, Federal Reserve)

**Bitcoin and Ethereum Hold Near 8-Month Highs Ahead of Xi State Dinner.** Bitcoin traded around \$85,134 on Monday — its highest level in 8 months — and held above \$86,000 by Tuesday morning, while Ethereum pushed to about \$2,746 and is now up 13.7% over the past month, even as both remain well below all-time highs of \$126,198 and \$4,953.73 set in late 2025. The bid comes as traders position for the Trump–Xi state dinner on September 24, where AI chips and semiconductors are expected to dominate the agenda. Polymarket already has 500 live markets tied to the visit, including a "Will Trump insult Xi?" tracker that last printed at single-digit pricing. (Yahoo Finance, Fortune, Polymarket)

**Oil Eases, Gold Steady as Traders Watch Iran Diplomacy and the Fed.** Brent crude fell 0.07% to \$99.18 a barrel and WTI slipped 0.39% to \$90.17 in early Wednesday trade, recovering modestly after Tuesday's WTI settlement near \$92.51. Gold held around \$4,380 per ounce (down 0.33% on Tuesday to \$4,328.89), with Polymarket pricing a 55% chance of an up-day on September 23 and 78% odds that XAUUSD closes above \$4,400 this month. Silver gained over 1% as easing oil eased inflation jitters; copper, soybeans and wheat moved on dollar flows tied to the hawkish Fed. (Trading Economics, CNBC TV18, Polymarket)

**SpaceX's \$85.7 Billion IPO Now the Benchmark for AI Listings.** SpaceX closed its record-breaking IPO in June, with the full over-allotment exercised bringing gross proceeds to approximately \$85.7 billion at a \$135 share price — and shares rocketed 19% on debut to push the company's value past \$2 trillion and crown Elon Musk the world's first trillionaire. With Anthropic now lining up its own \$2 trillion, \$100 billion raise for November and OpenAI watching from the wings at a \$750 billion private build-out commitment, SpaceX has set the new yardstick. The prospectus often-cited comparison to Saudi Aramco's 2019 \$25.6 billion listing now looks quaint. (Reuters, SEC filing)

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## AI & TECH

*The latest in models, compute, and the chip race*

**Anthropic Targets November Listing at \$2 Trillion Valuation, \$100 Billion Raise.** The WSJ reported on September 18 that Anthropic has pushed its IPO from October to November so it can show prospective investors a full quarter of financials, while talks center on a \$2 trillion valuation and a raise of up to \$100 billion — a deal that would eclipse SpaceX's June record. Lead underwriters are Morgan Stanley, Goldman Sachs, JPMorgan, and Citi. The pitch rests on a revenue run-rate that surged from about \$9 billion at end-2025 to \$65 billion by July 2026, with internal projections pointing to \$100-110 billion by year-end and roughly \$190-200 billion by 2028. Behind the scenes Anthropic has quietly locked down \$517 billion in compute contracts across at least 14.8 gigawatts of capacity. (WSJ via Reuters, The Information)

**Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang: Chip Sales Will Double Next Year.** Speaking at King Charles III's AI safety summit in Scotland on September 17, Jensen Huang told reporters he expects Nvidia to sell "twice as many chips next year as we do this year." The remarks sharpened a live dispute with Anthropic's Dario Amodei, who has called for slowing AI development — Huang insisted the buildout is only accelerating because "AI has so much contribution to the benefits of different industries." Shares rose about 2% to ~\$219 on the comment, even as official guidance still points to ~70% fiscal 2028 revenue growth (~\$673 billion) and CFO Colette Kress has revealed \$279 billion in legally binding supply commitments — about \$160 billion of which is tied to high-bandwidth memory pre-payments to SK Hynix, Samsung and Micron. (CNBC, Breitbart, AlInvest)

**Vera Rubin Begins Full Production as Nvidia's Next Compute Engine.** Nvidia's Rubin AI platform entered volume production on June 1, 2026 and is already running at Google Cloud, Microsoft Azure, Oracle, and CoreWeave. Each chip delivers up to 50 petaflops of inference compute — a 2.5x step over Blackwell — and cuts inference token costs by up to 10x. Nvidia is calling Rubin "the fastest product ramp in the company's history," with full Q4 2026 volume shipments targeting the Vera Rubin Ultra variant (~100 PF/GPU) in the second half of 2027. Rubin is the engine that makes Huang's doubling claim mathematically possible. (AlInvest, CNBC)

**Huawei Counterstrikes With Two New AI Chips and 1,000 Systems Deployed.** While Huang was in Scotland, Huawei announced plans to launch two new AI chips next year and disclosed it has already shipped more than 1,000 AI computing systems to over 370 customers, part of a Chinese push to cut reliance on US technology. Morgan Stanley estimates China's AI chip market will hit \$67 billion by 2030, with domestic firms taking 86% of that market (up from less than half in 2025). The timing matters: Huang is expected to attend Trump's state dinner for Xi Jinping on September 24, with AI and semiconductors front-and-center on the agenda. (CoinCentral, AlInvest)

**OpenAI Capped Microsoft Revenue Share, Locks In \$24.1B Annual Flow.** OpenAI moved roughly six months after its October 2025 restructuring to put a hard ceiling on the revenue share it pays Microsoft, ending an open-ended arrangement that had been paying out as OpenAI's run-rate exploded past \$40 billion annually. The disclosure buried in Microsoft's fiscal 2026 annual report showed \$24.1 billion of revenue booked from OpenAI arrangements (about 7% of Microsoft's \$331.8B annual total), with \$6.0 billion owed by OpenAI as of June 30. The April revision also lets OpenAI serve customers on any cloud provider, though Microsoft retains first-ship rights on Azure. (Motley Fool, TechBuzz)

**Claude Now Does ~26% of Anthropic's Own Research as Three Labs Sketch a Standards Body.** A late-September survey of frontier labs found Claude now leads roughly 26% of Anthropic's internal AI research workloads — a quiet milestone that the AI is not just serving customers but increasingly serving its creators. Separately, three of the largest labs are in early talks to formalize a shared standards body for model evaluation, a step that could finally give regulators a single benchmark to point to. (Third Run Time, AI Weekly)

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< **Polymarket 2028 Election Market:** The Trump-Xi, GOP nomination, and Presidential Election Winner 2028 markets have crossed \$708M in cumulative trading volume since their July 2025 launches. (Polymarket)

< **AI Researcher Warnings:** Anthropic researcher says AI has over a 10% chance of catastrophic outcomes, reshaping the public discourse on safety ahead of November's expected AI summits. (Spoken.md)

< **Apple/Samsung/LG:** No major chip alliance announcements in the past 24 hours; Rubin ramp remains the dominant data-center story.

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## THE TAKEAWAY

The macro setup heading into late September is unusually charged: the Fed just hiked rates for the first time in three years *and* told markets another one is coming, oil is hovering near \$92, gold is consolidating after a multi-month run, and the world's two largest economies sit down tomorrow for a state dinner where AI compute is reportedly on the menu. Behind that geopolitical theater, the real story is the AI capex curve — Anthropic lining up \$517 billion in compute contracts, Nvidia telling the market to expect a doubling of unit sales next year, and OpenAI simultaneously capping its Microsoft revenue share to keep more of its own explosive growth. Each of those data points would be a market-mover on its own. Together, they suggest that whoever wins the November listings calendar — Anthropic at \$2 trillion, OpenAI rumored at \$1.5 trillion-plus — will set the price for every private AI company that follows. The Fed's job is to keep inflation in check without breaking a market that is increasingly being valued on the assumption that AI revenue compounds at multiples of GDP.

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